CHÂTEAU DE FONTAINEBLEAU

FLAMME'S ROYAL STAMP TRAIL

13 STAMPS · 1 SECRET

Thirteen stamps hidden in a palace eight hundred years old — and one royal word to carry home.



BEFORE YOU START

Hello! I am Flamme.

FLAMME SAYS

I am a salamander, and I have lived in this palace for five hundred years. A king put me on his walls because people believed a salamander could sit in a fire and not burn.

I know every corner of this place – including the one nobody tells you about. Collect all thirteen stamps and I will show you the secret one.



1. Find the station on the map. Every one has a number and a stamping post.
2. Do the page FIRST. Look, count, fill in. Then you have earned it.
3. Press the stamp once, firmly, in the dotted square. Lift it straight up.
4. Copy your LETTER into the gold circle. Thirteen letters make one word.

THIS BOOK BELONGS TO .....

DATE ..... **AGE** .....

ONE RULE

A grown-up can help with the reading. The stamping is yours and nobody else's.

WHERE THE STAMPS ARE HIDING

The whole palace, from above



1. The Courtyard of the White Horse — *Cour du Cheval Blanc*
2. The Chapel of the Trinity — *Chapelle de la Trinité*
3. The King's Staircase — *Escalier du Roi*
4. The Gallery of François I — *Galerie François I*
5. The Ballroom — *Salle de Bal*
6. The Throne Room — *Salle du Trône*
7. The Empress's Bedroom — *Chambre de l'Impératrice*
8. The Turkish Room — *Boudoir Turc*
9. The Napoleon I Museum — *Musée Napoléon Ier*
10. The Chinese Museum — *Musée Chinois*
11. The Oval Court & the Golden Gate — *Cour Ovale & Porte Dorée*
12. Diana's Garden — *Jardin de Diane*
13. The Carp Pond — *Étang aux Carpes*
★ The SECRET stamp — *only when all 13 are done*

2–10 ARE INDOORS · 1 AND 11 IN THE COURTYARDS · 12 AND 13 OUTSIDE

WHO YOU WILL MEET

Four faces, one palace



FLAMME

Ageless

A salamander with a crown. François I put me on these walls 500 years ago and I have never left. I do not burn. I am also very good at hiding.



KING LOUIS IX

1214 – 1270

He came here to hunt in the great forest and loved the quiet of it. In his day Fontainebleau was a castle with a keep, not a palace.



KING FRANÇOIS I

1494 – 1547

He turned the old castle into a palace, brought artists over the Alps from Italy, and built the long gallery where Flamme lives.



EMPEROR NAPOLEON I

1769 – 1821

He called this place the house of the ages. He turned the king's bedroom into a throne room – and said goodbye to his army in the front courtyard.

? Draw a line from each person to the thing they left behind.

FLAMME	the long gallery
LOUIS IX	the throne and the golden bees
FRANÇOIS I	the salamander badge
NAPOLEON I	the oldest stones

ANSWERS ON THE LAST PAGE — BUT TRY FIRST!

STAMP 1 OF 13 · OUTSIDE · LETTER F

1 The Courtyard of the White Horse

Cour du Cheval Blanc

F

FLAMME SAYS

Walk to the middle and turn round. On 20 April 1814 Napoleon stood on these steps and said goodbye to his soldiers. That is why this courtyard has a second name: the Courtyard of Farewells.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

The staircase splits in two and curves. What everyday object is that shape?

1 Napoleon said goodbye to his army here on 20 April 18 ☐☐.

2 The staircase is shaped like a…

LADDER HORSESHOE TRIANGLE

CIRCLE ONE

3 Count the chimneys on the roof in front of you.

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

DID YOU KNOW?

The courtyard is named after a white plaster horse that stood here 500 years ago. The horse is long gone. The name stayed.



I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐:☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆☆☆☆☆

STAMP 2 OF 13 · INSIDE · LETTER O

2 The Chapel of the Trinity

Chapelle de la Trinité

O

FLAMME SAYS

Look UP, not down. The whole ceiling is a painting. A king was married under it – Louis XV, in 1725 – and a baby who grew up to become an emperor was christened under it in 1810.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Find one animal, one angel and one cloud in the ceiling.

1. A king was married in this room.

   TRUE FALSE

2. The ceiling is plain white stone.

   TRUE FALSE

3. Draw one thing you found on the ceiling.

DID YOU KNOW?

Kings watched mass from a balcony up at the back, so they never had to sit down with everybody else.

I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐ : ☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

STAMP 3 OF 13 · INSIDE · LETTER N

3 The King's Staircase

Escalier du Roi

N

FLAMME SAYS

This staircase used to be a BEDROOM. It belonged to a duchess. A hundred years after she slept here, the floor was taken out and her room became a grand staircase – which is why there are painted panels and plaster ladies high up, where nobody was ever meant to walk.



STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Look up at the walls. Can you work out where the ceiling of the old bedroom used to be?

1 This room used to be a…

KITCHEN BEDROOM STABLE

CIRCLE ONE

2 A room can change its ..... .

3 Count the plaster figures holding up the wall.

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

DID YOU KNOW?

The duchess's painted ceiling is still up there. Only her floor was taken away.

I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐ : ☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

STAMP 4 OF 13 · INSIDE · LETTER T

4 The Gallery of François I

Galerie François I

T

FLAMME SAYS

This is my home. King François I built this long gallery nearly 500 years ago and put ME on the walls, the ceiling and the woodwork. People used to believe a salamander could sit in a fire and not burn, so the king chose me for his badge and gave me a motto in Latin: NUTRISCO ET EXTINGUO.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Walk the whole gallery slowly. I am hiding more times than you think.

1 NUTRISCO ET EXTINGUO means: I _____ the good fire and I _____ the bad one.

2 The king's own letter is carved all along the gallery. Which is it?

C F S

CIRCLE ONE

3 SALAMANDER HUNT! One tick for every salamander you find.

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

DID YOU KNOW?

They say the king kept the only key to this gallery in his own pocket. Nobody walked down here unless he said so.



I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐:☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆☆☆☆☆

STAMP 5 OF 13 · INSIDE · LETTER A

5 The Ballroom

Salle de Bal

A

FLAMME SAYS

A room built for dancing, finished for King Henri II. Two shapes come back again and again on the walls, the floor and the ceiling: the letter H, and a crescent moon. The H is for Henri. The crescent moon was his badge – the way the salamander is mine.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Stand at one end. Ask a grown-up to whisper from the other end. Can you hear them?

1 Whose room is this? Circle the right letter.

F H N

CIRCLE ONE

2 The king's badge was a crescent _____ .

3 Count the crescent moons.

DID YOU KNOW?

The musicians played from a little balcony above the door, so the dancers got the whole floor to themselves.

I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐ : ☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

STAMP 6 OF 13 · INSIDE · LETTER I

6 The Throne Room

Salle du Trône

I

FLAMME SAYS

For nearly 200 years this was the king's BEDROOM. Then in 1808 Napoleon had the bed taken out and a throne put in. It is the only throne room left in France that is still standing in its own original room. Look for his letter N, and his little golden bees.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Find the N. It is in more than one place.

1. Before it was a throne room, it was the king's _____.

2. Napoleon put his throne here in 18 ☐☐.

3. Napoleon's letter is…

   F H N

   CIRCLE ONE

DID YOU KNOW?

Every single red and gold thing in this room was chosen to make one person look important. It worked.

I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐:☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

STAMP 7 OF 13 · INSIDE · LETTER N

7 The Empress's Bedroom

Chambre de l'Impératrice

N

FLAMME SAYS

The grandest bed in the whole château was made for Queen Marie-Antoinette. It was finished in 1787 – and she never once slept in it. Two empresses used it afterwards: Joséphine, and then Eugénie.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Look at the fabric. How many different patterns can you count in one wall?

1. The bed was made for Queen Marie- ..... .

2. She slept in this bed every night.

   TRUE FALSE

3. Draw the shape on top of the bed.

DID YOU KNOW?

The bed waited years and years for somebody to sleep in it. Imagine making your bed every morning for nothing.

I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐ : ☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

STAMP 8 OF 13 · INSIDE · LETTER E

8 The Turkish Room

Boudoir Turc

E

FLAMME SAYS

The smallest room on the trail, and the fanciest. It was made for Marie-Antoinette in 1777 as a tiny private room – somewhere to be ALONE in a palace full of people. The decoration copies the palaces of Turkey, nearly 2,500 km away.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Count the mirrors. Then work out why a small room feels so big.

1. A boudoir is a little room for being ..... .

2. This room copies the style of…

   TURKEY BRAZIL NORWAY

   CIRCLE ONE

3. Which one is NOT in this room?

   A MIRROR A DOME A STAIRCASE

   CIRCLE ONE

DID YOU KNOW?

A tiny room, decorated like a treasure box. It was the 1700s version of a secret den.

I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐ : ☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

STAMP 9 OF 13 · INSIDE · LETTER B

9 The Napoleon I Museum

Musée Napoléon Ier

B

FLAMME SAYS

Napoleon's own things. His hat is called a bicorne. BI means two and CORNE means horn, so it is a two-cornered hat. And look for his golden bees: he chose the bee for his badge because bees work together and never stop.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Find something here that belonged to a child.

1 BI means _____, so a bicorne hat has _____ corners.

2 Napoleon's badge was a…

BEE BEAR BUTTERFLY

CIRCLE ONE

3 Count the golden bees.

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

DID YOU KNOW?

Napoleon wore his hat sideways. Everyone else wore theirs front-on – so on a battlefield you could pick him out at once.



I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐:☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

STAMP 10 OF 13 · INSIDE · LETTER L

10 The Chinese Museum

Musée Chinois

L

FLAMME SAYS

Empress Eugénie made this room in 1863 to show things that came from China and from Siam – the country we now call Thailand. That is thousands of kilometres away, in a time long before aeroplanes. Everything in here arrived by ship.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Find a dragon. Then find a second one.

1 Empress Eugénie opened this room in 18 ☐☐.

2 Everything here travelled to France by…

PLANE SHIP TRAIN

CIRCLE ONE

3 Which one did NOT come from far away?

A SCREEN A JADE BOWL THE WINDOW

CIRCLE ONE

DID YOU KNOW?

Some of these objects had travelled further than almost anybody in France had ever been in their whole life.

I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐:☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

STAMP 11 OF 13 · OUTSIDE · LETTER E

11 The Oval Court & the Golden Gate

Cour Ovale & Porte Dorée

E

FLAMME SAYS

The oldest corner of all. Everything you have walked through was built on top of a medieval castle, and this egg-shaped courtyard still has the castle's shape. The square tower is the keep: the oldest building here, from the days of knights in armour. The Golden Gate beside it was the front door in 1528.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Stand in the middle and turn all the way round. Not one wall is straight.

1 This courtyard is shaped like…

A SQUARE AN EGG A STAR

CIRCLE ONE

2 Number these 1 to 4, oldest first.

- ☐ The Golden Gate (1528)
- ☐ The horseshoe staircase (1634)
- ☐ The medieval keep (the 1100s)
- ☐ The Louis XV wing (the 1700s)

DID YOU KNOW?

Eight hundred years of building, and nobody ever knocked the old castle down. They just kept building around it.



I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐ : ☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

STAMP 12 OF 13 · GARDEN · LETTER A

12 Diana's Garden

Jardin de Diane

A

FLAMME SAYS

Diana is the Roman goddess of hunting. She is standing in the middle of the fountain with a deer beside her, and around the bottom of the fountain bronze stags' heads pour out the water.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Walk all the way round the fountain before you answer the counting question.

1. Diana is the goddess of ..... .

2. The animal standing beside her is a…

   DEER HORSE LION

   CIRCLE ONE

3. How many stags' heads pour water into the fountain? .....

DID YOU KNOW?

Stand still and listen. Out here you can hear things you never hear inside: water, birds, gravel, wind. A palace has two kinds of quiet.

I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐ : ☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

STAMP 13 OF 13 · GARDEN · LETTER U

13 The Carp Pond

Étang aux Carpes

U

FLAMME SAYS

The kings kept fish here – to look at, and to eat. People say some of the carp in this pond are older than your grandparents, because carp can live a very long time. The little house out in the middle of the water is a pavilion: a room with no job except being a lovely place to sit.

STAMP HERE

LOOK FOR

Stand still at the edge for one whole minute and watch the water.

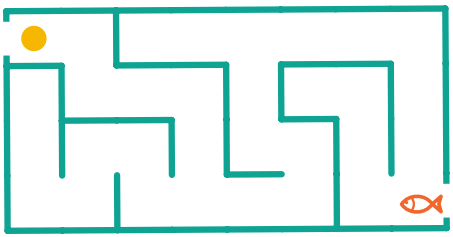
1 The little building in the middle of the water is a ..... .

2 A carp is a…

BIRD FISH FROG

CIRCLE ONE

3 Help my breadcrumb reach the hungry carp.





I STAMPED THIS AT ☐☐ : ☐☐

THIS ROOM GETS ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

THE SECRET STAMP · GARDEN

The Fountain of Beautiful Water

La Fontaine Belle Eau — Jardin Anglais

FLAMME SAYS

Here is the secret, and it is the best one. In this garden there is a spring: water that comes up out of the ground all by itself. Hundreds of years ago people called it the fontaine belle eau – the fountain of beautiful water. Say those three words quickly, and you have just said the name of this whole place.

SECRET STAMP

LOOK FOR

Water coming up out of the ground all by itself. Put one finger in. It is cold all year round.

1. FONTAINE means _____ .
2. BELLE means _____ .
3. EAU means _____ .
4. So **FONTAINEBLEAU** means:

_____

ONE LAST THING

Everybody who comes here says the name. Almost nobody knows they are saying "the fountain of beautiful water". Now you are one of the people who does.



THE LAST THING TO DO

The Royal Word

Write the letter from each stamp page into its own box, in order, 1 to 13. If you have them all, you have just spelled the name of this place – and you can claim the secret stamp.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13

FLAMME SAYS

Thirteen rooms, thirteen letters, one word. Say it out loud! Now go and find the fountain in the English garden, and you will find out what it means.

SECRET STAMP

MISSING A LETTER?

Go back. The stamp you missed is still there, and so is the room. Nothing here is in a hurry – it has been standing for more than eight hundred years.





YOUR TURN

Design your own badge

François I chose a salamander. Henri II chose a crescent moon. Napoleon chose a bee. Each of them picked something that said who they were — and then stuck it on absolutely everything they owned.

1 My badge is a .....

because .....

2 Draw it here. Hide your own letter in the picture, like the kings did.

3 My motto — a short line that goes with the badge:

.....

BEFORE YOU GO HOME

What I found today

1. The best thing I saw was .....

2. One French word I learnt: .....
   and it means .....

3. The oldest thing in the whole palace is the .....

4. Draw the best salamander you found, exactly where you found it.

5. Next time, I want to see .....

BY ORDER OF THE SALAMANDER

KEEPER OF THE ROYAL STAMP TRAIL

This is to certify that

.....

NAME

walked the whole Château de Fontainebleau, collected every stamp, found the secret fountain, and discovered the royal word.

.....

DATE

.....

GROWN-UP



GET THIS STAMPED AT THE SHOP

FOR GROWN-UPS · HOLD THE BOOK UPSIDE DOWN

Answers

1. The Courtyard of the White Horse – 14 · HORSESHOE · count varies – any honest number

2. The Chapel of the Trinity – TRUE · FALSE – it is painted

3. The King's Staircase – BEDROOM · job / use · count varies

4. The Gallery of François I – feed (nourish) / put out (extinguish) · F · there are dozens – any honest tally

5. The Ballroom – H · moon · count varies

6. The Throne Room – bedroom · 08 · N

7. The Empress's Bedroom – Antoinette · FALSE – she never slept in it

8. The Turkish Room – alone / quiet · TURKEY · A STAIRCASE

9. The Napoleon I Museum – two / 2 · BEE · count varies

10. The Chinese Museum – 63 · SHIP · THE WINDOW

11. The Oval Court & the Golden Gate – AN EGG · keep 1 · Golden Gate 2 · staircase 3 · Louis XV wing 4

12. Diana's Garden – hunting · DEER · 4 – check on the day

13. The Carp Pond – pavilion · FISH · follow the open path

★ **The secret** – fountain · beautiful · water. Fontainebleau = the fountain of beautiful water.

Who's who – Louis IX: the oldest stones. François I: the long gallery. Napoleon I: the throne and the golden bees. Flamme: the salamander badge.

The royal word – FONTAINEBLEAU.

The counting questions have no single right answer. They are there to slow a child down in front of an object. If they count eleven salamanders and you count fourteen, you have both won.



NUTRISCO ET EXTINGUO

"I feed the good fire,
and I put out the bad one."

The motto François I gave his salamander, painted and carved all over this palace since 1528.
Now you know where to look.

CHÂTEAU DE FONTAINEBLEAU
77300 Fontainebleau